else has to make the arrangements. I don't know about the cliché about a change being as good as a rest, but I do get a kick out of concentrating on something which is completely different than my usual routine. Sometimes it even means Victoria and I getting the chance to work together. That's great from the point of view of having time with each other. Our approaches to things like a filming day or a personal appearance are completely different, though. I'm pretty relaxed about it all:

'You get on with it and give me a shout when you need me.'

I like watching other people doing what they're good at, so a set or a studio can be a pretty interesting place to be.

Victoria, of course, has done far more of it over the years. That's probably why she's a lot sharper about it, wants to keep things moving, wants to make sure they're just right. She'll sometimes get a bit impatient with it all and those times, as it happens, she's usually right: she probably could do it better herself. I think we both do a decent job, even if we get round to it in different ways. It's just sometimes we'll have a go at each other a little along the way. Mind you, that's part of the deal: life with Victoria. Her making me think: have you seen this? Have you heard this? Have you done that? Her making me laugh, day in and day out. Being with her has made me look at everything, myself included, in a completely different way. I love how she is: awake from the moment she gets going in the morning. I've never known anyone be so alive: being married to Victoria is like being plugged into this no-batteries-needed energy source. And I'm buzzing thanks to her. Sometimes there's the odd short circuit but I've learned to give as good as I get. Victoria's the best company I've ever known.

I love us traveling together. We had a fantastic time in the summer of 2003 on the promotional tour we did through the Far East. I'd been to Japan before, of course, with England for the World Cup. The two of us heading out there to do work with a sponsor called TBC was a completely different experience. There's a whole thing about blonde Western women in Japan but Victoria's something else for them: she's a role model and a star but she's accessible too. Japanese women adore Victoria—the looks, the glamor, the attitude, the whole package. The same women seem to like me too. I think that's a bit strange: you can't really imagine a movie actor or famous musician from Japan making an impact in England in terms of their looks. I remember us talking to an American woman in Tokyo, who lives there and works for Def Jam records. She said that the way I look is only a small part of what's going on. In Japan, according to her at least, everyone's looking for the